

VS Code Workflow

A practical, Vim-friendly reference for navigating, testing, and staying oriented.

WINDOWS + WSL

Navigate the codebase

Open any file	Ctrl+P
Command Palette	Ctrl+Shift+P
Search the whole project	Ctrl+Shift+F
Symbols in this file	Ctrl+Shift+O
Symbols in workspace	Ctrl+T
Go back / forward	Alt+Left / Right
Go to definition	F12
Rename symbol	F2
Code action / quick fix	Ctrl+.

Window and views

Toggle Explorer sidebar	Ctrl+B
Toggle bottom panel	Ctrl+J
Explorer / Search / Git	Ctrl+Shift+E / F / G
Run and Debug / Extensions	Ctrl+Shift+D / X
Split editor	Ctrl+\
Format current file	Shift+Alt+F

Explorer and Outline

Focus Explorer	Ctrl+Shift+E
Expand / collapse a tree	Right / Left
Move through a tree	Up / Down
Filter the current tree	Palette → Filter

Use Outline for headings and symbols. Use breadcrumbs for path + symbol context.

Test and terminal: your bindings

Show or hide terminal	Ctrl+Alt+T
New terminal	Ctrl+Shift+`
Run the entire test suite	Ctrl+Alt+A
Run tests in this file	Ctrl+Alt+F
Run test at cursor	Ctrl+Alt+R
Debug test at cursor	Ctrl+Alt+D
Start debugging	F5
Toggle breakpoint	F9

Editing, copy, and Vim

Save / save all	Ctrl+S / Ctrl+K S
Close / reopen editor	Ctrl+W / Ctrl+Shift+T
Copy and paste editor text	Ctrl+C / V
Safe terminal copy / paste	Ctrl+Shift+C / V
Vim redo after u	Esc, Ctrl+R
Fallback editor redo	Ctrl+Y

TERMINAL RULE

You are WSL-first. Use the integrated Ubuntu terminal for project commands; it starts at the workspace folder.

Codex composer

Send a request	Enter or Ctrl+Enter
Insert a new line	Shift+Enter

Before changing Codex WSL settings: save editor work. VS Code reloads and recent chat UI state can disappear.

Three habits worth keeping

1. Find, do not browse **Ctrl+P**
2. Jump, do not hunt **Alt+Left / Right**
3. Focus the project **Multi-root workspace**

For a focused workspace, add only the folders you need as separate top-level folders.

Learn next: everyday defaults

Open Settings	Ctrl+,
Open Keyboard Shortcuts	Ctrl+K Ctrl+S
Go to a line	Ctrl+G
Find all references	Shift+F12
Open the Problems panel	Ctrl+Shift+M